

CONFLICT IN THE MIDDLE EAST, 1945–1995



Name:

Class:

Progress & Assessment Tracker

Progress & Assessment Tracker	Do Now	Level	Teacher Comment
KT3.1: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979	Do Now: / 10		
KT3.2: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993	Do Now: / 10		
KT3.3: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995	Do Now: / 10		
Final Unit Grade:			



Section B: Thematic Study (Medicine in Britain)

This section tests your understanding of change, continuity, and causation across 800 years of British medicine.

Question 3: Explain One Similarity or Difference...

4
Marks

5
mins

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Analyse similarity and difference across historical periods)

THE SYMMETRICAL SPLICING METHOD

[Comparative Thesis]

[Era 1: Context]

[Era 2: Matching Context]

Examiner Red Flags

The "Two-Story" Essay: Writing a block of facts about the first era, followed by a separate block about the second era without linking them is capped at 2 marks.

Concept Slippage: If the question asks about prevention, do not write about treatment.

Grade 9 Checklist

Immediate Comparison: Does my very first sentence make a direct comparison using a comparative connective?

Symmetrical Alignment: Do the details I provide for Era 2 directly match the theme of Era 1?

Chronological Blunders: Placing key developments in the wrong century.

Single-Paragraph Splicing: Is my answer written as a single, cohesive paragraph?

Question 4: Explain Why... (Causation)

12
Marks

15-18
mins

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Analyse causation) and AO1 (Demonstrate precise knowledge)

THE THREE-CAUSAL-PILLARS LAYOUT

No Introduction

Para 1

Stimulus A

Para 2

Stimulus B

Para 3

Own Knowledge

No Conclusion

Examiner Red Flags

The Stimulus Cap: Failing to introduce an independent third factor from your own knowledge caps your mark at 8/12.

The Narrative Biography Trap: Writing a chronological story instead of explaining *why* their work led to rapid progress.

Grade 9 Checklist

The Rule of Three: Have I structured my answer into exactly three separate paragraphs?

Causal Topic Openers: Does the first sentence of each paragraph state a clear, analytical cause?

Double Causal Connectives: Have I used the Edexcel

Connective Chain
("Consequently...", "This meant that...") at least twice per paragraph?

Question 5 & 6: Evaluative Essay

16+4 Marks

25-30 mins

TARGET OBJECTIVE

AO2 (Evaluate significance/change) and AO1 (Wide-ranging knowledge)

THE GRADE 9 JUDGMENT ARC

1

Intro

(Thesis & Criteria)

2

FOR

(Given Factor)

3

AGAINST

(Own Knowledge)

4

Conclusion

(Apply Criteria)

Examiner Red Flags

The One-Sided Argument:

Failing to analyze alternative factors traps your essay at Level 2 (8 marks).

"Fencing" Conclusions: Reaching a conclusion that simply states

Grade 9 Checklist

Explicit Evaluation Criteria:

Have I defined the historical criteria I will use to measure the statement?

The Argument AGAINST: Have I evaluated alternative factors using my own knowledge?

both sides were equally important.

Concept Slippage: Treating "care" and "treatment" as identical.

Substantiated Verdict: Have I explicitly applied the criteria established in my intro to justify which factor was most significant?

SPaG: Have I capitalized proper nouns and correctly spelled specialist terms?

KT3.1: Diplomatic negotiations, 1974–1979

Do Now Activity

Score: /10

1. Who succeeded Gamal Abdel Nasser as President of Egypt following his death in September 1970?

2. On which major Jewish holy day did Egypt and Syria launch their coordinated surprise attack in October 1973?

3. What was the name of the massive sand-wall fortification built by Israel along the east bank of the Suez Canal that Egyptian forces successfully overran?

4. Which global organisation, dominated by Arab oil-producing countries, implemented the 'oil weapon' in October 1973 to pressure Western nations?

5. What was the static, attrition-based conflict along the Suez Canal from 1969 to 1970 called, and which superpower provided Egypt with 15,000 advisors and SAM-3 missiles during it?

6. Why did Anwar Sadat make the dramatic decision to expel 15,000 Soviet military advisors from Egypt in July 1972?

7. Explain how the US military airlift, known as Operation Nickel Grass, influenced the course of the Yom Kippur War.

8. What were the two primary targets of Egypt's maritime blockade established in the years immediately following the 1949 armistice?

9. Explain the two key economic effects of the OPEC 'oil weapon' on Western nations supporting Israel in late 1973.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the outcome of the Yom Kippur War to the emergence of diplomatic negotiations in the mid-1970s.

Reference Image: The Yom Kippur War (1973)



Egyptian forces launching Operation Badr, successfully crossing the Suez Canal and breaching the Bar Lev Line on 6 October 1973.

Reference Image: The Camp David Accords (1978)



Egyptian President Anwar Sadat, US President Jimmy Carter, and Israeli Prime Minister Menachem Begin shaking hands after agreeing to the Camp David framework.

Vocabulary Check

Style: Contextual Cloze

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

OPEC | Shuttle Diplomacy | Likud | Camp David Accords | Treaty of Washington

The Yom Kippur War of October 1973 was a military conflict that triggered a global economic and geopolitical revolution. Alarmed by the massive US arms airlift to Israel (Operation Nickel Grass), the Arab members of OPEC (Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries) enacted the "Oil Weapon." They placed a total oil embargo on the United States, Denmark, and the Netherlands, while cutting production for other Western nations by 25%. This move had a devastating, cascading impact on the global economy. The price of crude oil quadrupled in a matter of months, skyrocketing from \$3 to \$12 a barrel. Western industrial nations, highly dependent on cheap oil, plunged into a deep economic crisis characterized by soaring inflation (rising prices) and high unemployment. As oil prices rose, production costs increased, making goods more expensive; consequently, consumers bought fewer items, leading to factory bankruptcies and mass layoffs.

THE COGNITIVE IMPACT OF OPEC'S EMBARGO

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graph TD; A[THE COGNITIVE IMPACT OF OPEC'S EMBARGO] --> B[United States Peace Incentive]; B --> C["Economy severely damaged by inflation and fuel shortages<br/>Realized they must stabilize the Middle East to prevent future oil crises"];
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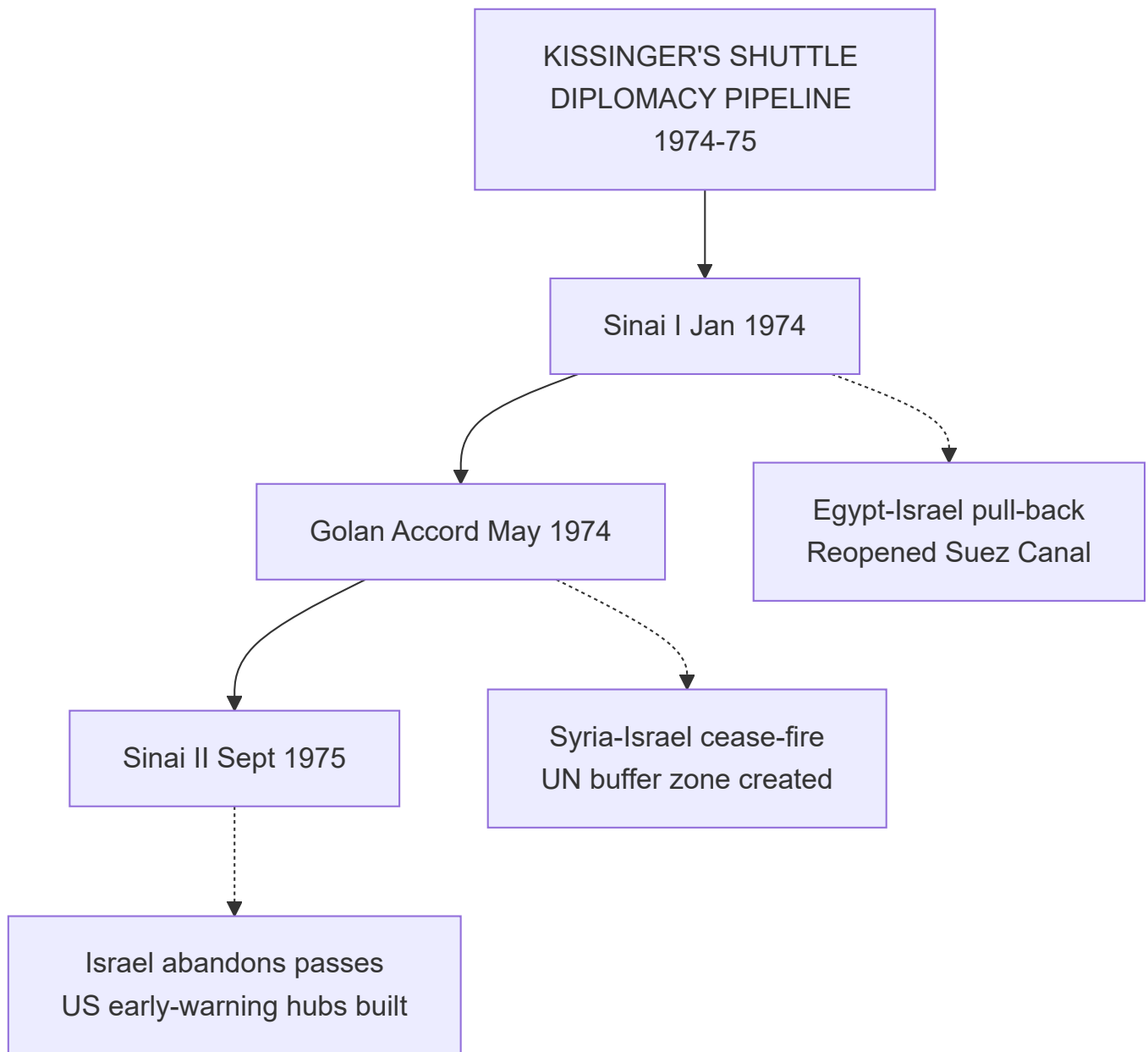
United States Peace
Incentive

Economy severely
damaged by inflation and
fuel shortages
Realized they must
stabilize the Middle East to
prevent future oil crises

and limit expanding Soviet influence in Egypt and Syria

For the superpowers, the crisis changed the calculation of Middle Eastern diplomacy. The Yom Kippur War had brought the United States and the Soviet Union to the brink of a nuclear confrontation. The United States, badly hit by the embargo, now had a powerful financial incentive to broker a lasting peace between Israel and its Arab neighbors to ensure the stable flow of Middle Eastern oil. Furthermore, US policymakers wanted to use diplomatic negotiations to pull Egypt out of the Soviet sphere of influence. Because Egypt and Syria refused to meet face-to-face with Israeli officials, US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger stepped in as a mediator. Kissinger pioneered a form of negotiation known as "shuttle diplomacy," flying back and forth between Cairo, Damascus, and Tel Aviv for two months to relay messages, draft proposals, and bridge the deep psychological divide between the hostile states.

Q1. How did the 1973 Yom Kippur War change the diplomatic calculations of the United States?



Kissinger's efforts produced three highly important interim agreements. The Sinai I Agreement (January 1974) saw Israeli forces pull back from the west bank of the Suez Canal, creating a UN-patrolled buffer zone. The Golan Accord (May 1974) brokered a cease-fire line on the Golan Heights, with Israel withdrawing from Quneitra. The Sinai II Agreement (September 1975) saw Israel surrender the strategic Gidi and Mitla passes and the vital Abu Rudeis oil fields to Egypt. Crucially, the US established manned early-warning electronic monitoring stations in Sinai to guarantee compliance. A direct consequence of Kissinger's Sinai I agreement was the clearing of the Suez Canal. The canal had been blocked since the 1967 Six Day War by sunken ships and landmines. On 5 June 1975—exactly eight years to the day after its closure—President Anwar Sadat officially reopened the Suez Canal to international trade, providing a major boost to the Egyptian economy.

Q2. What was the result of Henry Kissinger's Sinai II Agreement (September 1975)?

By 1977, the momentum of Kissinger's shuttle diplomacy had stalled. In May 1977, the right-wing Likud bloc came to power in Israel, with Menachem Begin installed as Prime Minister. Begin firmly believed in Israel's biblical claim to the entire Land of Israel, including the West Bank. Most observers assumed Begin's election would end all hopes of peace.

Sadat faces economic
collapse & riots



Realises conventional war
is too costly

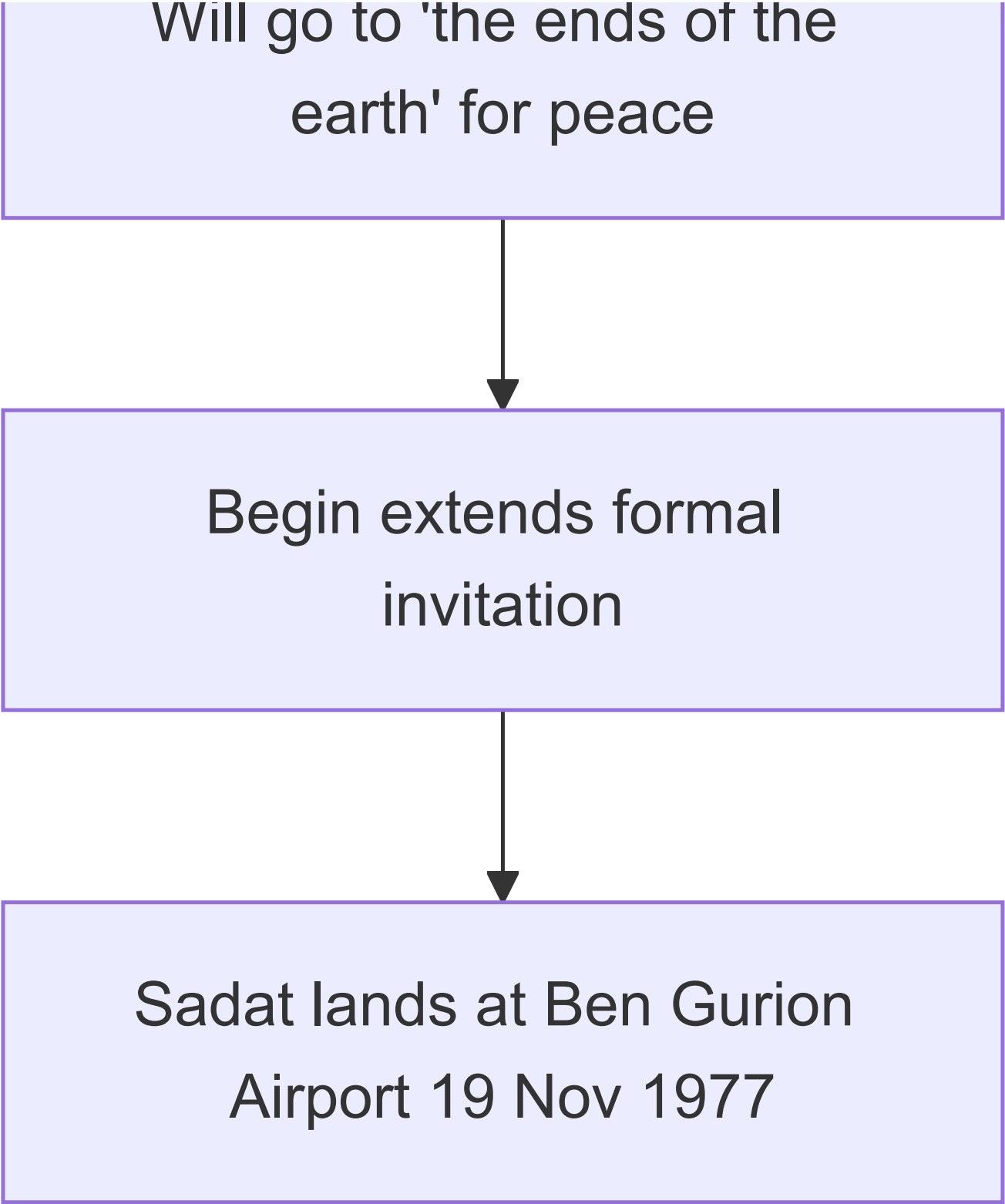


Declares to Egyptian
Parliament



Announces withdrawal from Sinai

Will go to 'the ends of the
earth' for peace



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graph TD; A[Will go to 'the ends of the earth' for peace] --> B[Begin extends formal invitation]; B --> C[Sadat lands at Ben Gurion Airport 19 Nov 1977];
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Begin extends formal
invitation

Sadat lands at Ben Gurion
Airport 19 Nov 1977

However, Anwar Sadat was facing severe internal pressures, a failing economy, and food riots in Cairo. Sadat realized only a dramatic, direct gesture could break the diplomatic deadlock. On 19 November 1977, Sadat's presidential plane landed at Ben Gurion Airport in Israel. The following day, he addressed the Israeli Knesset, offering Israel complete recognition and permanent peace in exchange for complete Israeli withdrawal from all occupied Arab lands. By mid-1978, direct talks between Egypt and Israel had once again broken down over Begin's refusal to dismantle Jewish settlements in the Sinai. To rescue the process, US President Jimmy Carter took a massive political risk, inviting both Sadat and Begin to the presidential retreat at Camp David, Maryland, for face-to-face negotiations.

Q3. What dramatic gesture did Anwar Sadat make on 19 November 1977 to break the diplomatic deadlock?

THE CAMP DAVID
SUMMIT SEPT 1978

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graph TD; A[THE CAMP DAVID SUMMIT SEPT 1978] --> B[13 Days of Seclusion]; B --> C[Jimmy Carter's Mediation]; C --> D[Two Framework Agreements];
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13 Days of Seclusion

Jimmy Carter's Mediation

Two Framework
Agreements

For 13 days, Carter acted as a tireless mediator. The grueling summit resulted in the signing of the Camp David Accords on 17 September 1978. Framework 1 addressed the wider Palestinian issue, agreeing to a five-year transitional period of autonomy for the West Bank and Gaza Strip. Framework 2 outlined a bilateral peace treaty: Israel agreed to a phased, complete withdrawal from the Sinai Peninsula, and Egypt agreed to normalise relations. On 26 March 1979, Begin, Sadat, and Carter signed the formal Treaty of Peace between Egypt and Israel (the Treaty of Washington). Israel returned the entire Sinai Peninsula to Egypt, which became demilitarised. In return, Egypt officially recognized Israel's right to exist, becoming the first Arab nation to do so. The Suez Canal and the Straits of Tiran were permanently open to Israeli maritime shipping.

Q4. Outline the key terms of Framework 2 of the 1978 Camp David Accords.

Sinai returned to Egypt
phased



Egypt grants diplomatic
recognition to Israel



Sinai demilitarised &
monitored



1979 Camp David Accords

Suez Canal & Straits of Tiran fully open to IDF

While celebrated in the West, the peace treaty triggered a massive geopolitical backlash in the Middle East. The Arab League expelled Egypt for abandoning the Palestinian cause. Tragically, on 6 October 1981, Anwar Sadat was assassinated by radical Islamic militants within the Egyptian army who opposed his peace with Israel. Begin also faced furious opposition from hardline settlers, but the Knesset approved the treaty with a massive majority of 84 votes to 19.

Q5. What was the tragic personal consequence for Anwar Sadat following the signing of the peace treaty?

Q6. Explain one consequence of the 1973 Oil Crisis for diplomatic negotiations in the Middle East. (4 marks)

GCSE Exam Practice

- ☐ Emerging (1-2)
- ☐ Emerging+ (3)
- ☐ Expected (4-5)
- ☐ Expected+ (6-7)
- ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT3.2: The Palestinian Issue, 1974–1993

Do Now Activity

Score: /10

1. Who was the US Secretary of State who pioneered the stage-by-step mediation strategy known as 'shuttle diplomacy' following the 1973 Yom Kippur War?

2. In what month and year did Egypt officially reopen the Suez Canal to international shipping, exactly eight years to the day after its closure?

3. Explain how the 1973 Oil Crisis acted as a direct catalyst for the United States to become heavily involved in Middle Eastern diplomacy.

4. Which right-wing, revisionist Zionist leader won the May 1977 Israeli election, ending nearly thirty years of Labor Party dominance?

5. Explain how Anwar Sadat's historic visit to Jerusalem in November 1977 broke a decades-long Arab diplomatic taboo.

6. Name the two distinct framework agreements that comprised the Camp David Accords signed on 17 September 1978.

7. Detail the primary bilateral terms of the Treaty of Washington signed on 26 March 1979.

8. How did the wider Arab world react to Egypt signing a separate peace treaty with Israel in 1979?

9. Explain the domestic backlash and political fallout that both Anwar Sadat and Menachem Begin faced within their own countries after signing the peace agreements.

10. Using a relative clause and an analytical linking phrase, write a single sentence showing how the 1973 Oil Crisis historically connected to the Treaty of Washington (1979).

Reference Image: The First Intifada (1987)



A Palestinian youth throwing a stone at an Israeli tank during the First Intifada, highlighting the asymmetric nature of the conflict.

Vocabulary Check

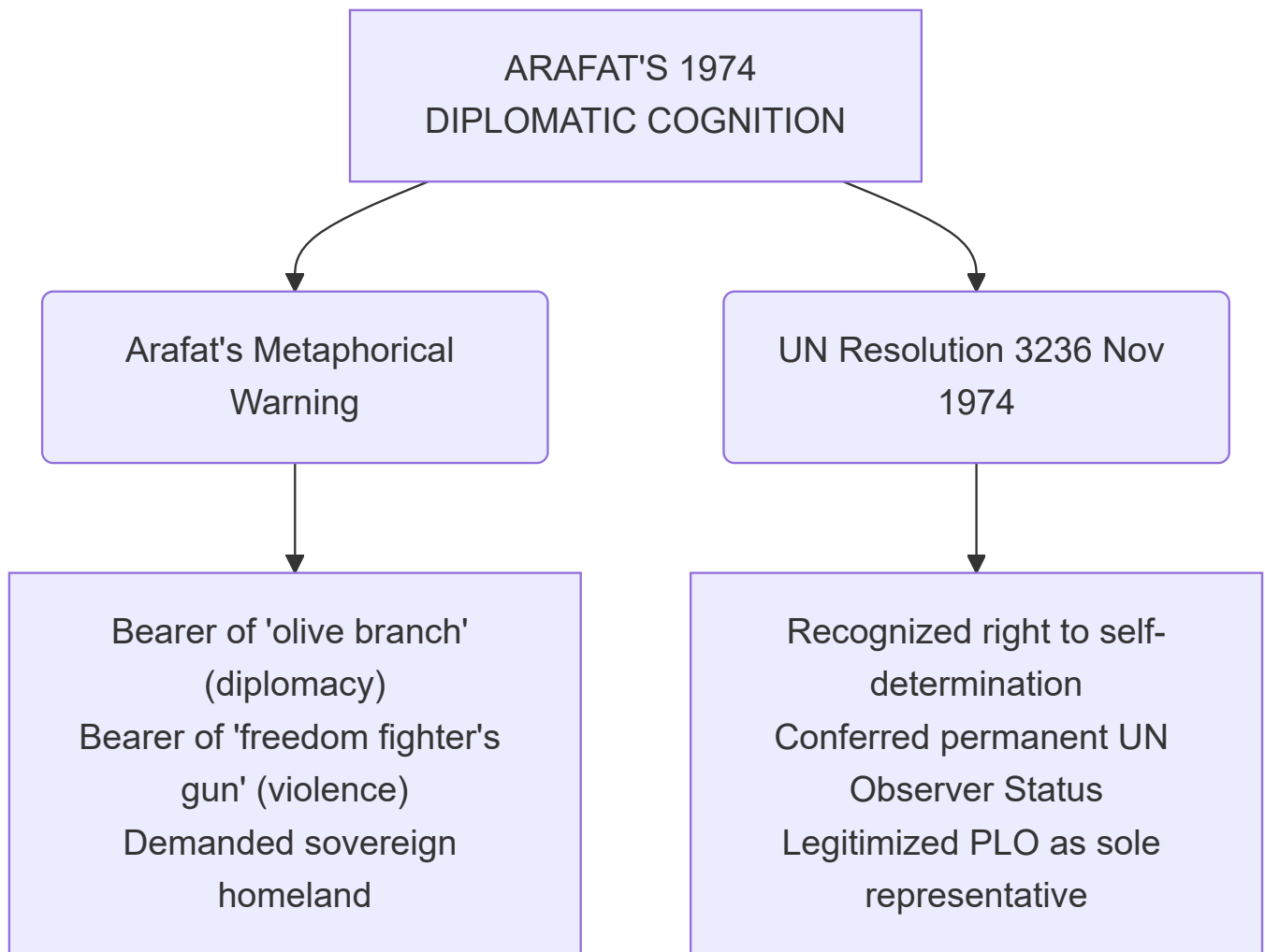
Style: Vocabulary Mapping

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

**UN Resolution 3236 | Fatahland | Operation Peace for Galilee | Sabra and Shatila
| First Intifada | Hezbollah**

Your Sentence:

Following the 1973 Yom Kippur War, the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) sought to capitalize on the shifting geopolitical landscape to advance its diplomatic standing. On 13 November 1974, PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat made a historic address to the United Nations General Assembly in New York. This invitation was highly significant, representing the first time a representative of a non-state national movement was permitted to address the UN General Assembly plenary. Arafat, who delivered his speech wearing his signature checkered keffiyeh and olive-green uniform, famously concluded his remarks with a powerful metaphorical warning: "I have come bearing an olive branch and a freedom fighter's gun. Do not let the olive branch fall from my hand."



This dual-track message signaled that while the PLO was prepared to engage in international diplomacy to secure a sovereign Palestinian state, it would not abandon its armed struggle if diplomatic avenues were blocked. The diplomatic offensive yielded immediate results at the UN. Resolution 3236 formally recognized the inalienable rights of the Palestinian people to self-determination, and granted the PLO permanent Observer Status. At the Arab League Summit in Algiers, the PLO was officially recognized as the "sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian nation." Following its bloody expulsion from Jordan during the "Black September" civil war of 1970, the PLO relocated its central leadership, military apparatus, and thousands of fighters to Lebanon. Lebanon was an ideal haven: its central government in Beirut was weak, and the country already hosted over 400,000 Palestinian refugees living in camps.

Q1. What was the significance of UN Resolution 3236 (November 1974) for the PLO?

THE RISE OF 'FATAHLAND' IN LEBANON



PLO Expelled from Jordan
1970



PLO Establishes HQ in
Southern Lebanon



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Cross-Border Katyusha
Rocket Attacks



Galilee Settlements
Targeted



1975 Lebanese Civil War
Erupts



PLO Allies with Leftist
Muslim Coalition

By the mid-1970s, the PLO had established a powerful "state-within-a-state" in southern Lebanon, widely known as "Fatahland". The PLO operated its own checkpoints, collected taxes, ran hospitals, and established military training camps. From these bases, PLO guerrilla fighters launched cross-border raids and fired Katyusha rocket barrages into northern Israel, terrorizing the civilian settlements of the Galilee region. On 11 March 1978, a Fatah commando unit launched the Coastal Road Massacre, hijacking a civilian bus and engaging in a gun battle that resulted in the deaths of 37 Israeli civilians. In direct retaliation, Prime Minister Menachem Begin ordered the IDF to launch Operation Litani on 15 March 1978.

Q2. What was 'Fatahland' and how did it threaten Israeli security?

Fatah Coastal Road
Massacre 37 Dead



Operation Litani Launched
March 1978



IDF Occupies Southern
Lebanon Buffer Zone



UN Truce in Lebanon

UN Security Council Resolution 425



UNIFIL Deployed to Border



Israel Builds South
Lebanon Army SLA Militia

Over 26,000 IDF troops invaded southern Lebanon, occupying a 10-kilometer-wide security strip. The UN established the United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) to confirm the Israeli withdrawal. Israel withdrew but left control of the buffer zone to a friendly, pro-Israeli Christian militia known as the South Lebanon Army (SLA). The UNIFIL buffer failed to stop the conflict. The final trigger for full-scale war occurred on 3 June 1982, when the Abu Nidal Organization shot and critically wounded Shlomo Argov, Israel's ambassador to Great Britain. Although British intelligence confirmed the PLO was not responsible, Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon used the assassination attempt as the necessary pretext to launch a long-planned, total invasion of Lebanon: Operation Peace for Galilee.

Q3. What pretext did Israeli Defense Minister Ariel Sharon use to launch Operation Peace for Galilee in June 1982?

THE 1982 LEBANESE INVASION



Ambassador Shlomo Argov
Shot 3 June



Operation Peace for
Galilee 6 June



1982 LEBANESE INVASION

IDF Bypasses UNIFIL and
Races North



Heavy Syrian Air Clashes
100 MiGs Shot Down



Siege of West Beirut
Encirclement



14,000 PLO Fighters
Evacuated to Tunis

Evacuated to Tunis

On 6 June 1982, Israeli forces launched a massive armored invasion. Ariel Sharon secretly harbored much larger geopolitical ambitions: to completely destroy the PLO in Lebanon, defeat Syrian forces, and install a pro-Israeli Christian government in Beirut led by Maronite leader Bashir Gemayel. By mid-June, Israeli forces surrounded Lebanon's capital, trapping Yasser Arafat and 15,000 PLO fighters in West Beirut. For over two months, Israel subjected the city to relentless bombardments. To prevent total destruction, a multinational peacekeeping force supervised the evacuation of Yasser Arafat and over 14,000 fighters by ship to Tunis, Tunisia.

Q4. What were Ariel Sharon's larger geopolitical ambitions behind the 1982 invasion of Lebanon?

Having successfully expelled the PLO, Israel's close Maronite ally, Bashir Gemayel, was elected President of Lebanon. However, on 14 September 1982, Gemayel was assassinated in a massive bomb blast by Syrian agents.

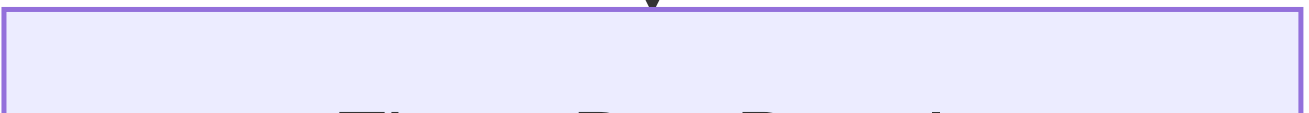
Bashir Gemayel
Assassinated 14 Sept



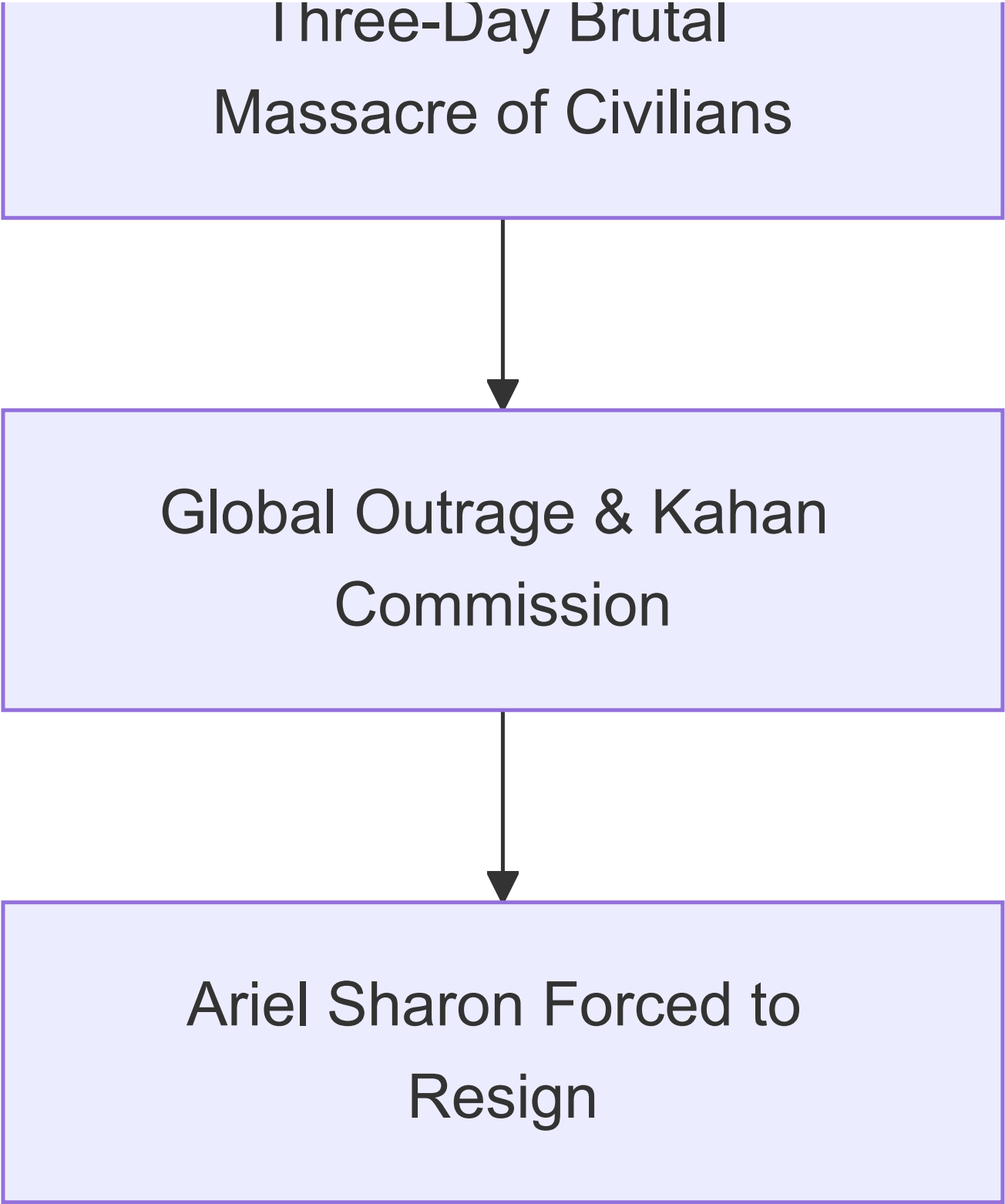
IDF Encirclement of Sabra
& Shatila Camps



Phalangist Militias Allowed
Into Camps



Three-Day Brutal
Massacre of Civilians



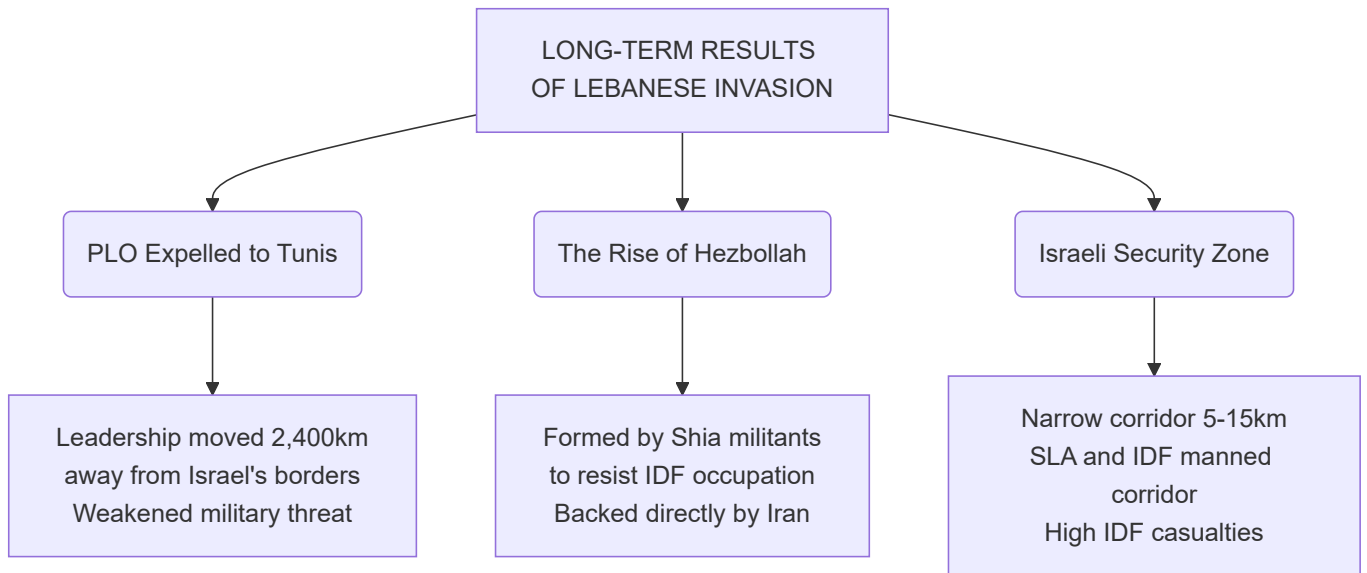
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graph TD; A[Three-Day Brutal Massacre of Civilians] --> B[Global Outrage & Kahan Commission]; B --> C[Ariel Sharon Forced to Resign];
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Global Outrage & Kahan
Commission

Ariel Sharon Forced to
Resign

In response to the assassination, the IDF occupied West Beirut. On 16 September 1982, Israeli forces surrounded the Palestinian refugee camps of Sabra and Shatila. Claiming PLO terrorists remained inside, Ariel Sharon authorized the Lebanese Christian Phalangist militias to enter the camps to clear them. Fueled by anger over the death of Gemayel, the Phalangists systematically slaughtered unarmed civilians. While the IDF held the perimeter and illuminated the night skies with flares, the militias murdered between 800 and 3,500 people. The revelation of the atrocities triggered immediate, furious international condemnation. The extraparliamentary peace movement "Peace Now" organized a protest of 400,000 Israelis in Tel Aviv. The Kahan Commission concluded that Defense Minister Ariel Sharon bore "personal, indirect responsibility" for the tragedy. He was forced to resign.

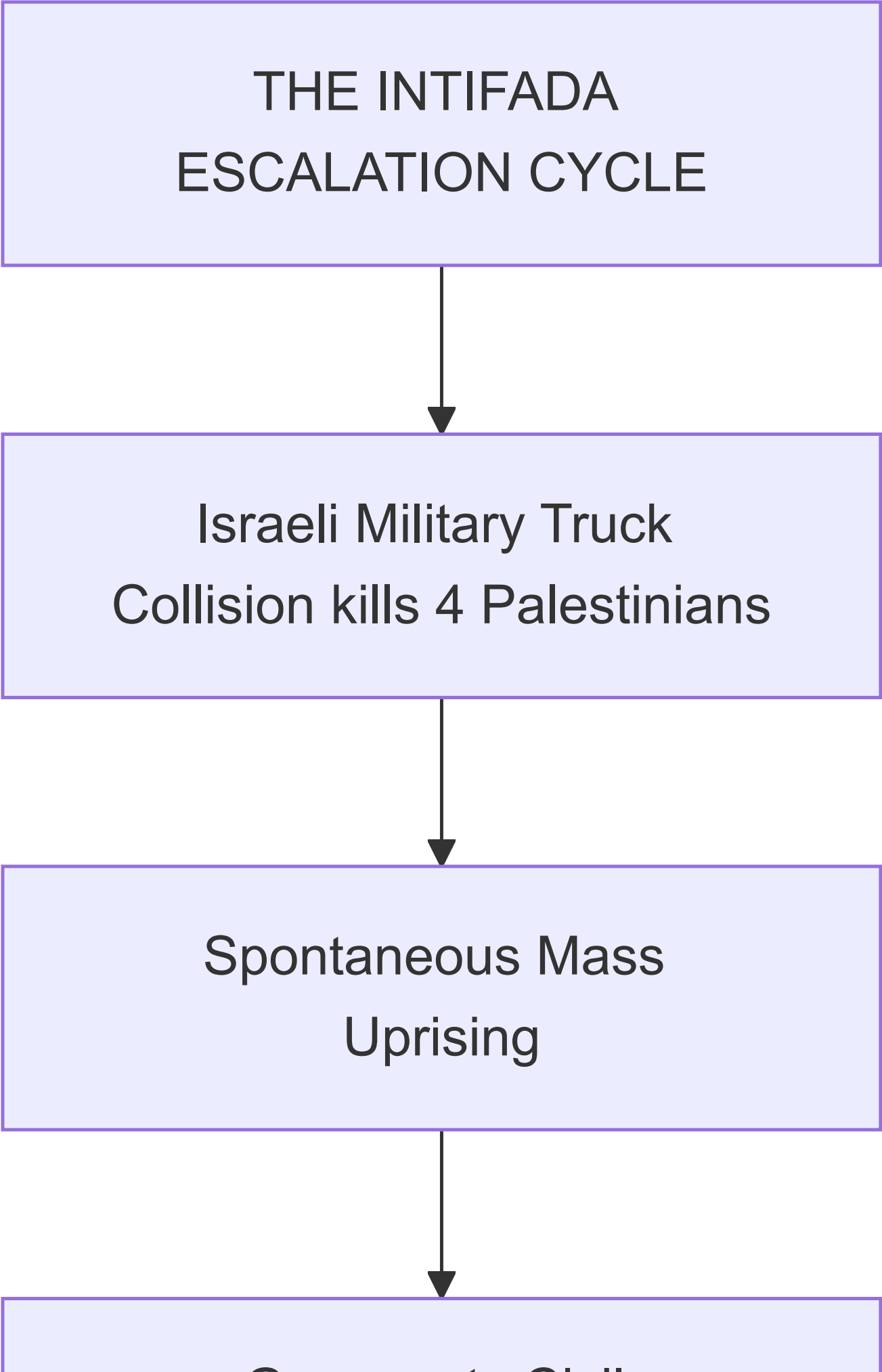
Q5. Describe the events and consequences of the Sabra and Shatila massacre in September 1982.



While the PLO leadership remained isolated in Tunis, the core of the Palestinian struggle shifted back to the occupied territories. On 8 December 1987, an Israeli military truck collided with a civilian car, killing four Palestinians. The local population erupted in massive demonstrations that swept across Gaza and the West Bank, marking the start of the First Palestinian Intifada ("The Shaking Off").

Q6. What event marked the start of the First Palestinian Intifada in December 1987?

THE INTIFADA ESCALATION CYCLE



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graph TD; A[THE INTIFADA ESCALATION CYCLE] --> B[Israeli Military Truck Collision kills 4 Palestinians]; B --> C[Spontaneous Mass Uprising]; C --> D[...];
```

Israeli Military Truck
Collision kills 4 Palestinians

Spontaneous Mass
Uprising

...

Grassroots Civil
Disobedience & Stone
Throwing



Yitzhak Rabin's 'Iron Fist'
Reprisal



Global Sympathy Shifts to
Palestinian Cause



Emergence of Militant

Emergence of Militant Hamas

Unlike the PLO operations, the First Intifada was a grassroots, popular civilian uprising utilizing non-violent civil disobedience (strikes, boycotts) alongside low-level street violence. The iconic visual of the Intifada consisted of Palestinian youth throwing stones at heavily armored Israeli tanks. Israeli Defense Minister Yitzhak Rabin responded with a severe "Iron Fist" policy, ordering the IDF to "break the bones" of demonstrators. However, television cameras broadcasted graphic footage of heavily armed soldiers beating stone-throwing children across the globe. For the first time, global public sympathy shifted decisively toward the Palestinian cause, severely damaging Israel's international moral standing.

Q7. How did the First Intifada shift global public sympathy toward the Palestinian cause?

CONSEQUENCES OF THE FIRST INTIFADA

For the PLO	For Israel	The Rise of Hamas
Forced Yasser Arafat to renounce terrorism and officially accept the two-state solution (1988) to retain leadership.	Convinced Yitzhak Rabin and military planners that there was no purely military solution to the Palestinian issue.	Formed in 1987 as a rival to the PLO, Hamas rejected compromises and conducted violent armed attacks against Israelis.

Writing Historically: Level 9 Stylistic Masterclass

GCSE history examiners actively look for clear, sophisticated written expression that demonstrates analytical links between historical causes, events, and consequences.

- **1. Using Relative Clauses to Pack in Evidence (AO1):** Add vital historical information directly to a noun using relative pronouns like 'who', 'which', or 'whose'. For example: *Yasser Arafat, who addressed the UN General Assembly in 1974 wearing his signature keffiyeh and military uniform, successfully secured international legitimacy...*
- **2. Using Noun Phrases in Apposition (AO1):** Place two noun phrases side-by-side to provide concise historical detail. For example: *Ariel Sharon, the hardline Israeli Defense Minister, launched Operation Peace for Galilee in June 1982.*

- **3. Using Present Participles (AO2):** Link cause and effect using verbs ending in '-ing'. For example: *...Palestinian guerrillas launched frequent cross-border attacks, **provoking** disproportionate Israeli military reprisals.*

Q8. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments of the PLO in Lebanon in the years 1970–82. (8 marks)

GCSE Exam Practice

- ☐ Emerging (1-2)
- ☐ Emerging+ (3)
- ☐ Expected (4-5)
- ☐ Expected+ (6-7)
- ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

KT3.3: Attempts at a solution, 1988–1995

Do Now Activity

Score: /10

1. What was the famous metaphor Yasser Arafat used in his historic 1974 address to the United Nations General Assembly?

2. What major diplomatic status did the UN General Assembly award the PLO under Resolution 3236 following Arafat's speech?

3. Why did the PLO choose to relocate its central headquarters and fighters to Lebanon after being expelled from Jordan in 1970–71?

4. What was 'Fatahland,' and how did its existence affect northern Israeli security?

5. Explain the short-term trigger that Ariel Sharon used as a pretext to launch the June 1982 invasion of Lebanon.

6. Following the Siege of Beirut in August 1982, where were Yasser Arafat and the PLO leadership evacuated to under international supervision?

7. Why did the Israeli Kahan Commission (1983) find Defense Minister Ariel Sharon 'indirectly responsible' for the Sabra and Shatila massacre?

8. What spontaneous event in December 1987 served as the immediate catalyst for the outbreak of the First Palestinian Intifada?

9. Describe the civilian tactics of the First Intifada and explain why Yitzhak Rabin's military response backfired internationally.

10. Write an analytical sentence linking the First Palestinian Intifada to the emergence of Hamas.

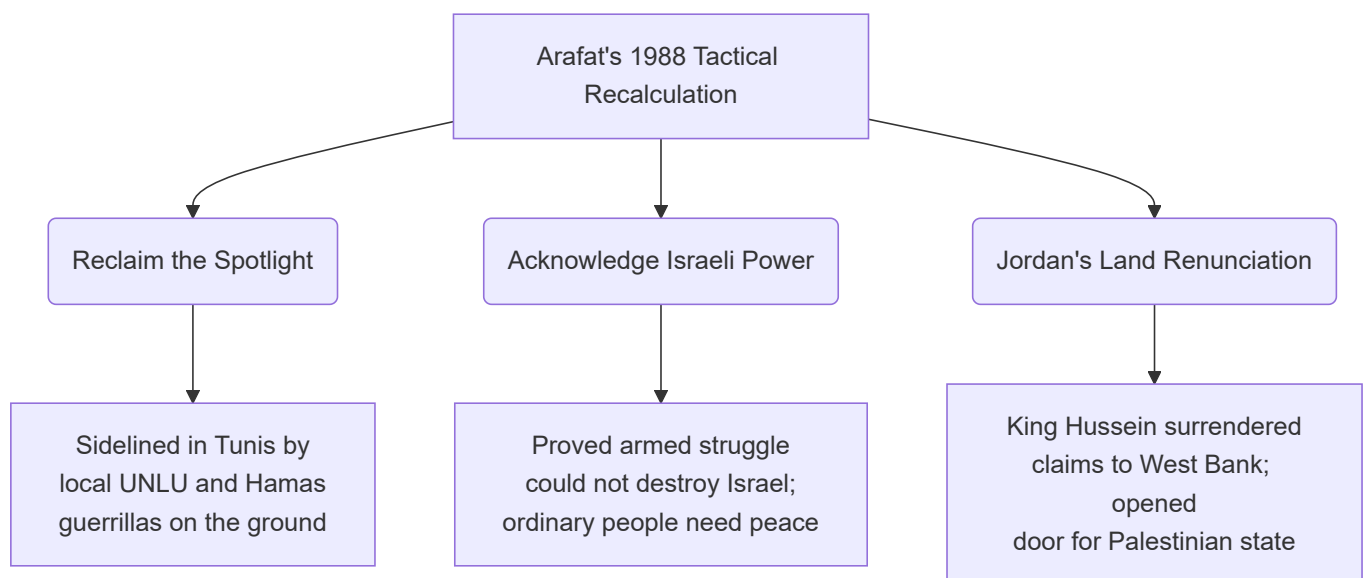
Vocabulary Check

Style: Mini-Frayer Model

Complete the Frayer Model for the term: **UNLU**

Definition	Historical Example
Non-Example / Sketch	Your own sentence

By late 1988, PLO Chairman Yasser Arafat realized that the political landscape was shifting beneath his feet. The First Palestinian Intifada had been launched and coordinated by grassroots local committees on the ground, bypassing the traditional PLO leadership isolated in Tunis. Arafat faced a major dilemma: his leadership was being rapidly overshadowed by new, highly popular underground leaders in the Unified National Leadership of the Uprising (UNLU) and radical Islamist groups like Hamas and Islamic Jihad.



To regain political control, Arafat enacted a historic shift in PLO strategy. In November 1988, the Palestinian National Council officially accepted the principles of partition and a two-state solution—officially recognizing Israel's right to exist alongside a sovereign, independent Palestinian state in the occupied territories. In December 1988, on the strict insistence of the United States, Arafat delivered a historic speech to a special session of the UN General Assembly in Geneva. In this speech, Arafat explicitly renounced and condemned all forms of terrorism. This met the long-standing US conditions for official diplomatic contact, forcing the Reagan administration to open formal diplomatic talks with the PLO.

Q1. How did Yasser Arafat enact a historic shift in PLO strategy in late 1988?

The international geopolitical order was completely transformed between 1989 and 1991. The dissolution of the Soviet Union (USSR) in December 1991 brought an end to the Cold War and fundamentally altered the balance of power in the Middle East.

THE SOVIET COLLAPSE GEOPOLITICAL DOMINO EFFECT



USSR Dissolves Dec 1991



PLO loses main finance &
arms supplier



... ..

200000 Soviet Jews
migrate to Israel



Settlement expansion in
West Bank



Unemployed Palestinians
displaced



Arafat pressured to seek
urgent peace

The collapse of the USSR was a devastating blow to the PLO, which lost its primary funding and diplomatic backing. Over 200,000 Soviet Jews migrated to Israel, leading to the expansion of Jewish settlements in the West Bank and displacing Palestinian workers. Arafat realized he had to secure a deal immediately. The end of the Cold War also meant the US emerged as the sole global superpower and used its leverage, threatening to withhold a \$10 billion loan guarantee, to force Israel's Prime Minister Yitzhak Shamir to negotiate. In August 1990, Iraqi dictator Saddam Hussein invaded Kuwait, triggering the 1991 Gulf War. Arafat made the disastrous decision to publicly support Saddam Hussein.

Q2. How did the collapse of the Soviet Union in 1991 severely damage the PLO's geopolitical position?

Arafat backs Saddam
Hussein in Gulf War



Gulf States cut off vital
PLO funding



PLO is diplomatically &
financially isolated



10/1000

US/USSR co-sponsor
Madrid Conference 1991

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graph TD; A[US/USSR co-sponsor  
Madrid Conference 1991] --> B[Direct Arab-Israeli talks  
deadlocked]; B --> C[Paves way for secret  
Norwegian channel];
```

Direct Arab-Israeli talks
deadlocked

Paves way for secret
Norwegian channel

Outraged by Arafat's betrayal, wealthy Gulf Arab states cut off all financial donations. Kuwait expelled over 300,000 Palestinian workers. The PLO was left bankrupt. To stabilize the region, the US and USSR co-sponsored the Madrid Peace Conference in November 1991. While the public talks stalemated, they broke the taboo of direct negotiations. In June 1992, the moderate Labor Party came to power in Israel under Yitzhak Rabin. Rabin authorized secret, back-channel negotiations in Oslo, Norway.

Q3. Why was the PLO left bankrupt and diplomatically isolated following the 1991 Gulf War?

Labour Government
elected under Yitzhak Rabin



Secret talks opened in
Norway Dec 1992



Hamas launches first
suicide bombings 1993



Peace process begins

Rabin views PLO as a
moderate alternative



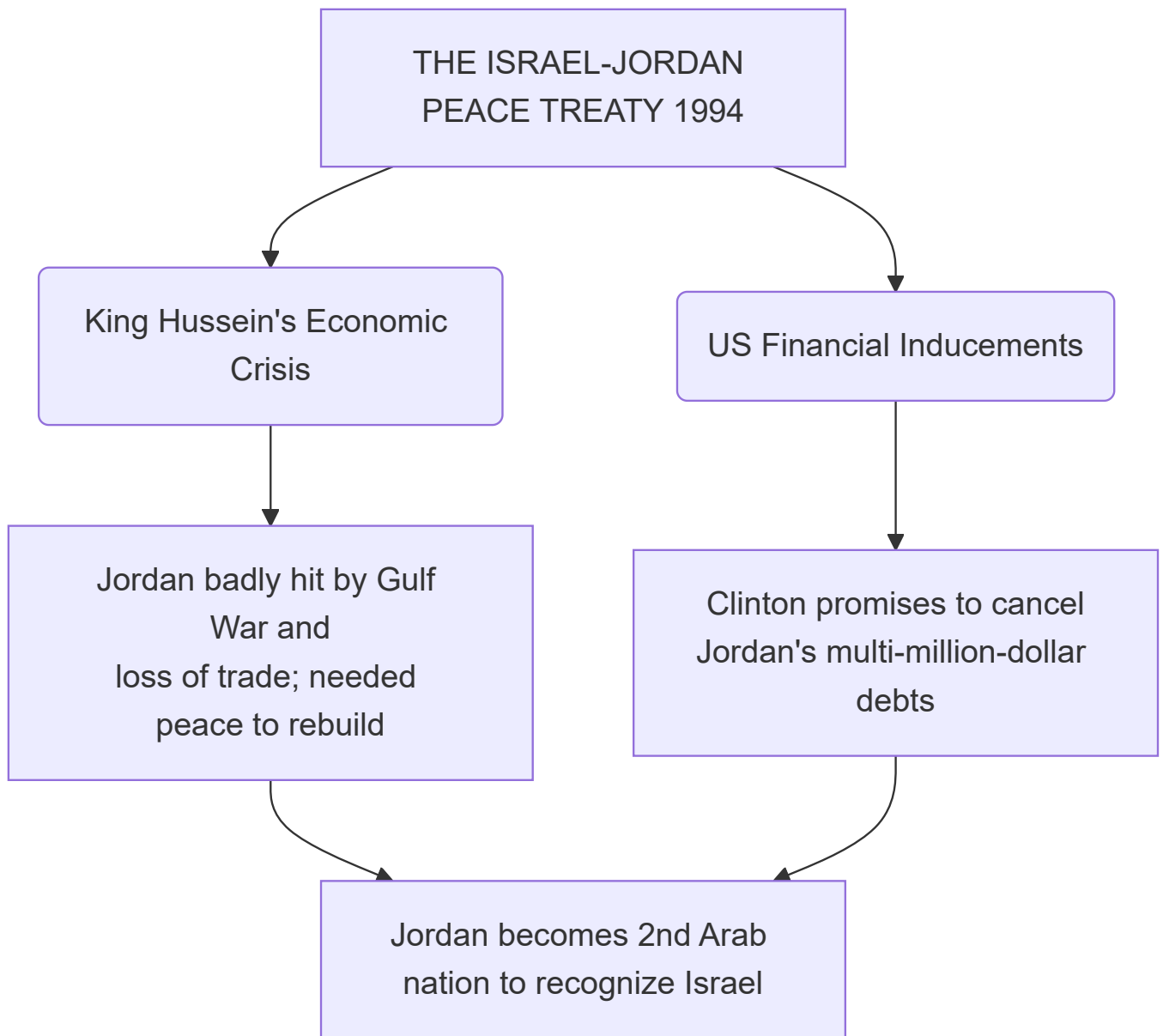
Arafat and Rabin sign Oslo
I Accords



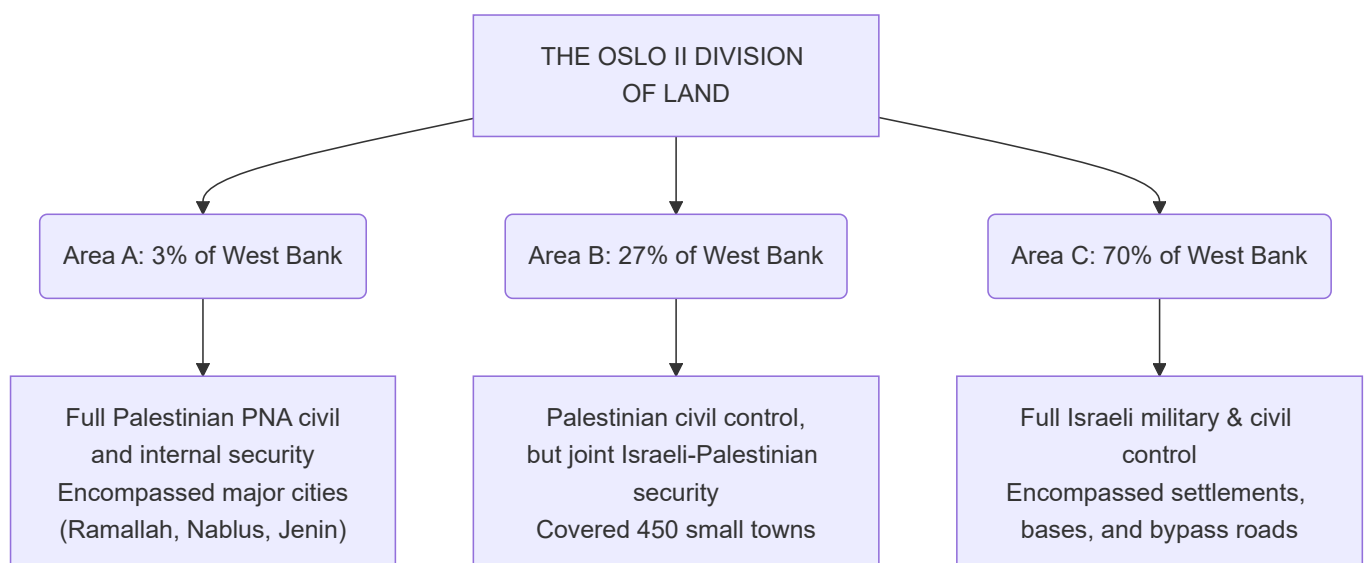
Establishment of
Palestinian Authority PNA

The urgency intensified in April 1993 when Hamas launched its first suicide car bombing. This convinced Rabin that Arafat's PLO was a moderate alternative. The secret negotiations produced the historic Oslo I Accords, signed on the White House lawn on 13 September 1993. Arafat renounced terrorism and recognized Israel, while Rabin recognized the PLO. An interim Palestinian National Authority (PNA) was established to govern Gaza and Jericho. In October 1994, Israel and Jordan signed a formal Treaty of Peace. King Hussein approached Rabin because Jordan was suffering economically after the Gulf War. US President Bill Clinton promised to cancel Jordan's massive debts if it normalized relations.

Q4. What convinced Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin to engage in secret negotiations with the PLO in 1993?

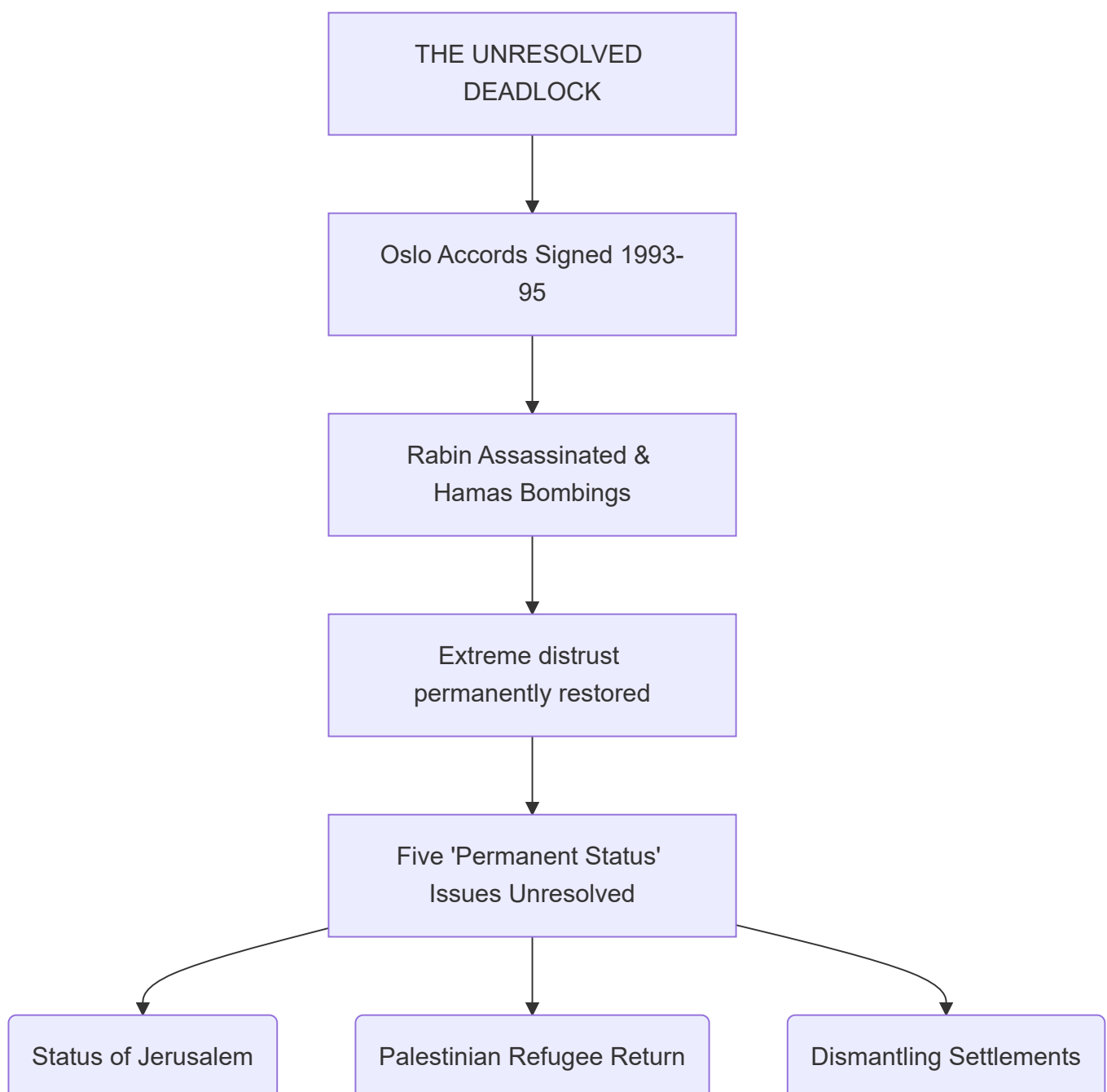


On 28 September 1995, Rabin and Arafat signed the Oslo II Accords, which detailed the expansion of Palestinian self-rule across the West Bank by dividing it into three zones.



While Oslo II was celebrated, the division triggered a massive political backlash. Palestinians were frustrated that the PNA only controlled a fragmented archipelago (Area A), while Israel still controlled 70% of their land (Area C). Hamas launched suicide bus bombings. Right-wing Israelis were outraged by Rabin's concessions.

Q5. Why did the Oslo II Accords trigger a massive political backlash among Palestinians?



On 4 November 1995, Yitzhak Rabin was assassinated at a peace rally in Tel Aviv by Yigal Amir, a radical right-wing Jewish law student. The assassination dealt a fatal blow to the peace process, leaving the "permanent status" issues completely unresolved.

Q6. What event dealt a fatal blow to the peace process on 4 November 1995?

Q7. Write a narrative account analysing the key developments in the peace process between Israel and the Palestinians in the years 1988–95. (8 marks)

The tragic assassination of Rabin highlighted the deep structural flaws of the Oslo Accords. While celebrated internationally as a breakthrough, the agreement was fundamentally ambiguous. It intentionally delayed the most difficult "permanent status" issues—such as the final borders, the status of Jerusalem, the right of return for Palestinian refugees, and the dismantling of Israeli settlements—to a later date. This delay created a dangerous vacuum of uncertainty. Right-wing Israelis viewed any land concessions as a threat to national security and biblical claims, while Palestinian hardliners argued that the PNA had essentially become a subcontractor for Israeli security, failing to deliver true sovereignty or halt settlement expansion. Ultimately, the Accords required a high level of mutual trust that simply did not exist on the ground.

Q8. Explain why the Oslo Accords were considered 'fundamentally ambiguous' and structurally flawed. (12 marks)

GCSE Exam Practice

- ☐ Emerging (1-2)
- ☐ Emerging+ (3)
- ☐ Expected (4-5)
- ☐ Expected+ (6-7)
- ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:
